{Portfolio}

Kshirabdija

Human-Centered Design, Interactive Prototyping, Narrative Interaction Design, Creative Coding & Data Experiments

print("hello")

```
// Java
print("Crafting designs that fuse physical and digital experiences")

# python
description1 = "Storytelling through UI/UX, motion,visuals and a dash of Python—because why not?"

<!-- HTML -->
<p>Merging code, color, and craft to re imagine the way we connect and communicate.</p>

<!-- Tailwind CSS:  -->
<p class="text-lg font-dark text-gray-900 my-4">Prototyping ideas, debugging culture, and crafting more inclusive experiences.</p>
```

computer languages

Education

Srishti Manipal Institute Of Art And Design:
B.Des Creative and Applied Computation.
Vidyashilp Academy, Bengaluru:
High School Degree

Experience

Dr.Reddys, Hyderabad- senior experience designer
May 2025- July 2025
Art in Transit, Bengaluru— creative intern
June 2024 - July 2024
Gokuldas exports, Bengaluru— Design Intern
July 2023

Languages

English -Primary language
Hindi - Mother tongue
Kannada- (B2) Upper- Intermediate
French- (A1) Beginner
Computer languages:
Java, Arduino IDE, Python, R, p5.js

Software

Procreate, Adobe Premiere Pro, InShot, Fusion, Onshape, Figma, Framer, SketchUp, Brackets, Anaconda, google docs, Google slides, Microsoft excel, DaVinci Resolve

Connect

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About me

I design at the intersection of technology and people, across Figma, code, and circuit boards. I've redesigned medical device websites, built accessibility tools tested with real users, and wired self-driving cars inspired by octopus cognition.

I'm drawn to problems where design can change how someone experiences the world.

Bengaluru · Open to UX, product design, and creative technology roles.

Projects

Dr:REDDYS

INTERNSHIP

UI/UX design
Web development
Wire-framing & Prototyping
User Research
Branding

Namma Raste

24 HR PROJECT

Speculative design
Service design
UI/UX
Branding

Octopod

8 DAY PROJECT

Bio-inspired Speculative Interaction Design
Concept & Narrative Development
Storytelling & Visualizations
Motion & Behavior Design

Ex-blurE

PRE-THESIS PROJECT

UI/UX design
web development
Wire-framing & Prototyping
User Research
Branding
Service design
Development

CITY AS TEXT

THESIS PROJECT

Research
Branding
Service design
Storytelling & Visualizations
Concept & Narrative Development

INTERNSHIP

DR.REDDY

what is nerivio?

Nerivio is an FDA-cleared wearable neuromodulation device designed to help people manage migraine through remote electrical stimulation. As the product expanded into the India and UK markets, the team needed a unified yet region-specific digital presence that clearly communicated the science, guided first-time users, and built trust in a clinically advanced therapy. I joined the project as a designer working at the intersection of UX, research, and product communication, helping translate complex medical technology into accessible experiences for patients, caregivers, and healthcare professionals.

THE PROBLEM WE FACED

Nerivio is FDA-cleared and clinically proven, but the India website wasn't communicating that. A cluttered navigation buried the "How It Works" section, product imagery was disconnected from the copy around it, and the language was too clinical for a patient who just wants to know: will this help my migraines?

MY ROLE

Executing designer on the India and UK website redesign, Amazon product page, and early UX for the KART-T therapy site — working under a senior designer whose sign-off shaped final decisions.

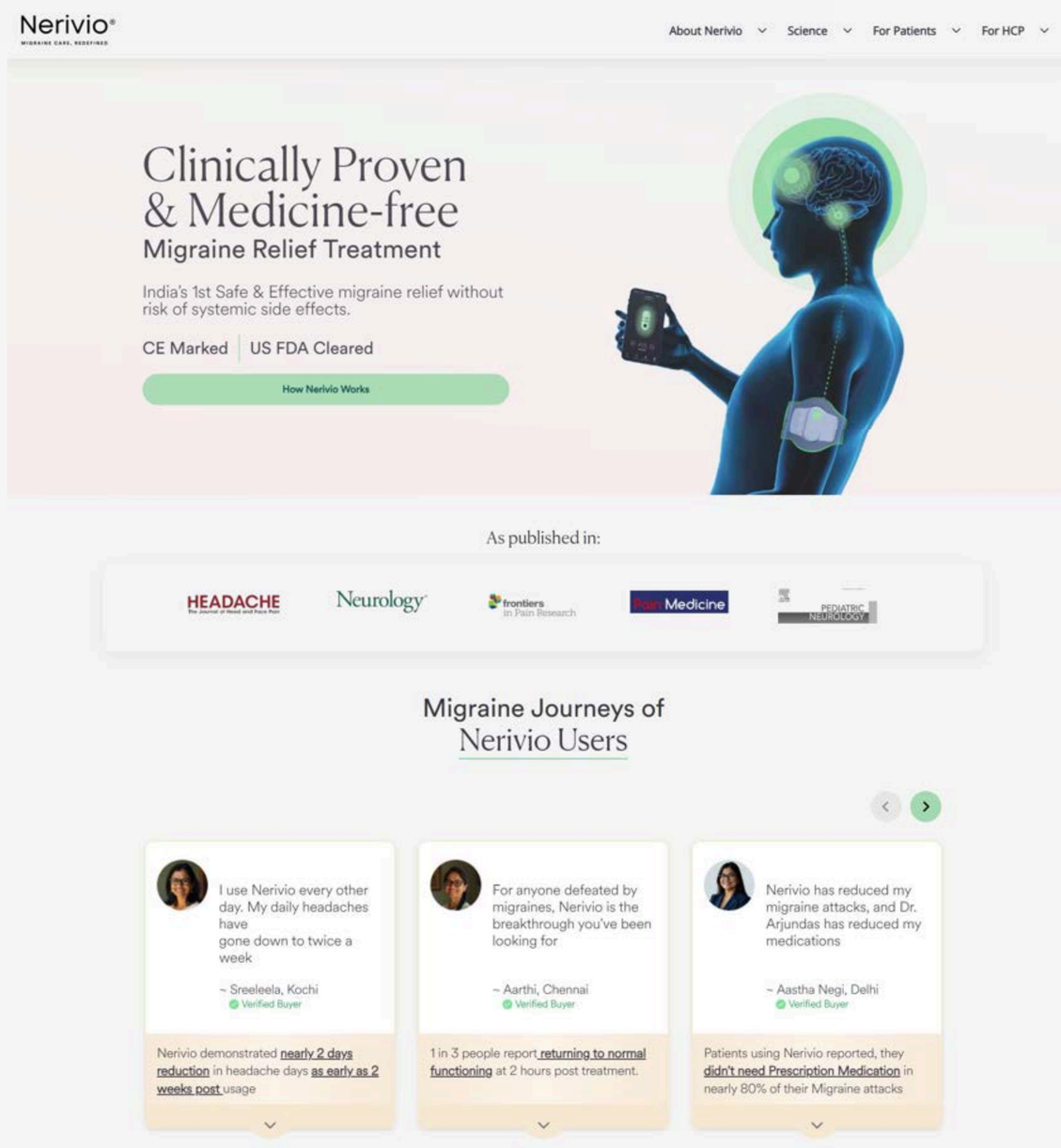
WHAT I CHANGED & WHY

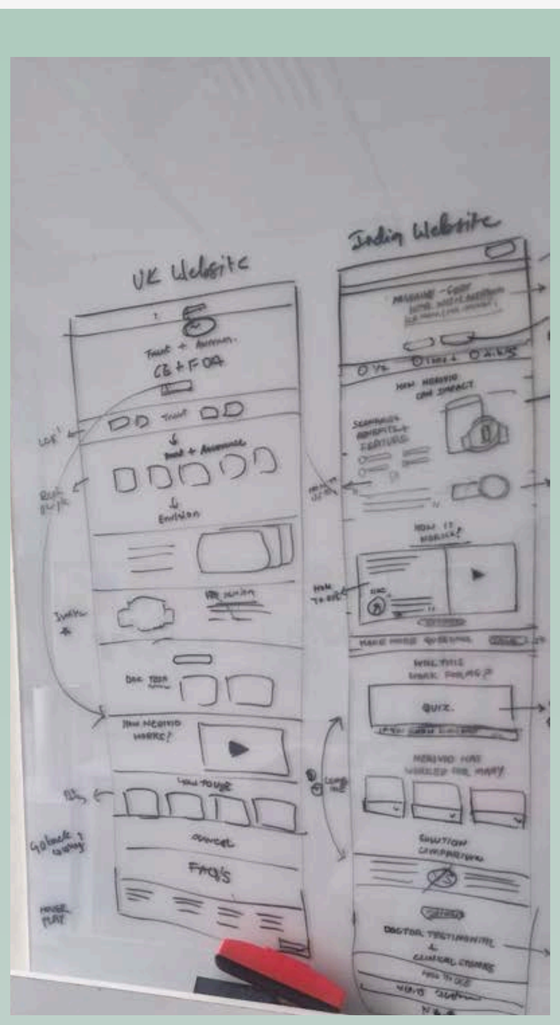
Navigation — The original nav had too many items with no clear hierarchy. A patient's first question is "does this work and how?" so I reorganised the structure to surface "How It Works" immediately, with Science and For Patients as secondary paths.

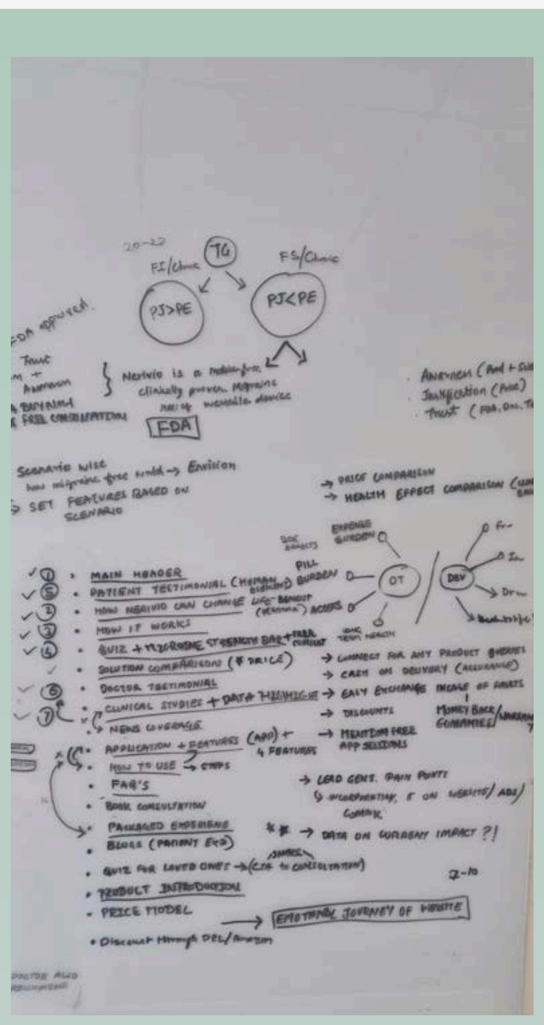
Imagery — The existing visuals didn't match the surrounding content. I directed a product photoshoot using the site's colour language, building a step-by-step visual sequence of the device in use — so the page reads as a coherent story rather than disconnected panels.

Copy — Dense, jargon-heavy text was rewritten to lead with patient outcomes, with clinical data supporting rather than leading. Colour contrast issues were also corrected for readability.

The redesign shipped. The live site (nerivio.in) reflects this structure. The delivery was well-received by both the internal team and the client.







WORKING ON THE NERIVIO WEBSITE FLOW

WORKING ON THE NERIVIO PRODUCT PHOTOSHOOT

SIDE PROJECTS

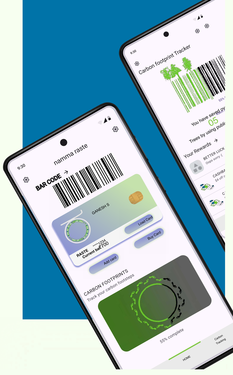
Alongside the Nerivio work, I contributed to several internal communication and organisational initiatives. I helped design **internal emailers** that simplified complex medical information for cross-functional teams and ensured consistent visual communication across departments. I also supported the **planning and setup of Impact Day**, an internal event focused on cardiovascular diseases, where I assisted with content design, visual assets, and experience flow. In parallel, I worked on the **early UX and structural design for the KART-T therapy website**, which is currently in development, helping establish its information hierarchy, clinical content layout, and interface direction.

24 HR PROJECT

NAMMA RASTE

prayana nimadu, daari namadu

A unified public transport payment platform:
bringing bus, metro, and last-mile services into one seamless, cashless experience.



30% metro-to-bus transfers

60% bus-to-metro connections

95% walk-to-metro

1-...

Project overview

One card. Every ride.

Namma Raste is a unified public transport payment platform designed to streamline commuting across Bengaluru. It brings together bus, metro, and last-mile services into a single, seamless payment system, no need for cash or multiple cards

A physical card and digital app work together, giving access to all points of time to every commuter, regardless of their banking status.

Problem Statement

How might we solve the issue of multiple ticketing platforms for transport overcoming navigation struggles?

Bengaluru's commuters juggle multiple ticketing systems across buses, metro, and auto services. Digital passes exist but lack visibility. Fares are inconsistent, stops are undocumented, and the unbanked population is entirely excluded from digital transit. The result: friction, confusion, and cash dependency at every touchpoint.

Research insights

What we found on the ground.

Largest

Buses are the most widely used mode of transport for last-mile connectivity, yet the most fragmented payment-wise.

Low Visibility

Digital passes exist but a lot of commuters don't know about them, no promotion, no discoverability at stops or on buses.

Fare Confusion

Inconsistent fares due to non-availability of actual route pricing. Public places have little to no information on fares.

The solution

Why Namma Raste?

A single card and app that works across all public transit in Bengaluru, making every commute faster, cheaper, and greener.
No cash. No confusion. No multiple apps.

Unified Platform
One system for bus, metro, and last-mile services

Cashless & Secure
Physical card + QR/barcode digital payments

Discounts & Rewards
Earn Yatri points with every ride

Easy Top-Up
Recharge from the app, or kiosks.

Flexible Time Frame Passes
Day, week, or monthly commuter passes

Carbon Tracker
Visualize and reduce your carbon footprint

Lifetime Validity
Card never expires, balance always retained

Lite Mode
Compressed images, cloud-based, low storage

Digital product

The 5 screens that tell the story.

leading the app UI and visual identity, we wanted every screen was built around one principle: clarity at a glance, a commuter shouldn't have to think. The carbon tracker was a deliberate addition, tying sustainable behaviour to tangible rewards rather than just awareness.

01 *Home Screen*

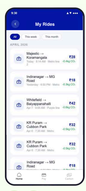
The command centre. Balance, quick actions, Scan to Pay, and a carbon snapshot all above the fold.

Wallet balance · Scan to pay CTA · Quick actions · Carbon preview · Recent rides

02 *Scan & Pay*

One screen, one action. QR and barcode toggling for gate access. Balance always visible.

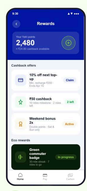
Wallet balance · Scan to pay CTA · Quick actions · Carbon preview · Recent rides



03 *Ride History*

Every journey logged with route, time, fare, and CO_2 impact. Monthly stats at the top. Filter by week or month for quick expense tracking.

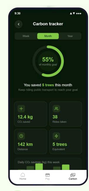
Wallet balance · Scan to pay CTA · Quick actions · Carbon preview · Recent rides



04 *Rewards*

Yatri points earned with every ride. Cashback offers, streak bonuses, and eco-rewards that tie green behaviour to real rupee value.

Wallet balance · Scan to pay CTA · Quick actions · Carbon preview · Recent rides



05 *Carbon Tracker*

The green heart of Namma Raste. Every bus ride earns CO_2 credits. A ring chart, weekly bar graph, and tree-equivalent metric make sustainability tangible.

Wallet balance · Scan to pay CTA · Quick actions · Carbon preview · Recent rides

Digital product

The Raste Card

Physical + Digital.
Always in sync.
A physical and digital form of the card is provided to users giving access to all points of time to every transit touchpoint across Bengaluru.
The card works even without a smartphone, making it inclusive for every type of commuter.

Lifetime validity · NFC + Barcode · ✓ Works offline · NFC + Barcode · ✓ Works offline · NFC + Barcode · ✓ Works offline · NFC + Barcode

Brand identity

Built on trust and motion.

Color system

#EAEAEA	A soft neutral canvas that reduces eye strain and lets the two accent colours stand out.
#83CA49	Universally signals go and sustainability, reinforcing every ride as a small win for the planet.
#0217A3	Deep and authoritative, evoking the trust and reliability commuters already associate with public infrastructure.

The branding drew from Kannada letterforms: the logo references the letter ರ (ra), connecting the product visually to the city it serves.

Typography

NOKA — MAIN TEXT – NOKA (DISPLAY)

Helvetica — SUB & BODY TEXT – HELVETICA

Clean, geometric, legible at speed. Designed for real-world commuter scanning distances.

Customer journey

From discovery to loyalty.

Awareness
Commuter hears about Namma Raste through ads, social media, or word of mouth.
- Social media platforms
- Physical bus stop posters
- Flyers & pamphlets

Consideration
Customer researches Namma Raste's benefits and costs.
- Visits website or reads pamphlets
- Checks metro station banners
- Customer reviews online

Purchase
Customer visits nearby metro station, bus depot, or convenience store.
- Completes card registration
- Purchases online/at kiosks

Purchase
Customer activates the card through a tutorial, app, or customer service.
- App walkthrough
- SMS activation flow
- Kiosk help point

Usage
Customer taps card at metro gates or on buses. Seamless travel.
- No worrying about cash
- Real-time balance via app
- Top up on the go

Post-purchase & Loyalty
Customer receives promotional offers, travel points, and refers friends.
- Cashback & Yatri points
- Eco-rewards for green travel
- Referral bonuses

Customer journey

From discovery to loyalty.

Key Partners
- State government
- BMTC / BMRCL
- Payment gateways
- Telecom companies
- Tech providers

Key Resources
- Funding & investment
- App dev team
- Cloud infrastructure
- Physical card materials

Revenue Streams
- Commissions from public transport
- Card manufacturing fees
- In-app advertisements
- Government subsidies

Channels
- Mobile application
- Social presence
- Advertisements
- Partnerships

Customer Segments
- Students
- Working professionals
- Wholesalers
- General public
- Tourists

Value Proposition
- Unified platform
- Seamless travel
- Cashless & Secure
- Carbon tracker
- Lifetime card validity

Scalability & feasibility

Bengaluru first, India next.

Namma Raste is currently targeted at the Bengaluru metropolitan area. The service has the potential to scale to a national level, serving multiple cities and states as a Unified Public Transport Payment System — cutting across all public transport services (metro, buses, suburban trains) under a single platform.

City to Nation:
Starting with Bengaluru's metro area, with a clear path to scale across multiple Indian cities under one unified platform.

Anti-Fraud by Design:
Digital transactions replace cash, reducing theft, double-purchases, and ticketing errors at every touchpoint.

Standardised Fares:
One consistent pricing system across all operators, eliminating confusion and fare manipulation.

One Card, Every Region:
Commuters can travel seamlessly across different cities and transport modes using a single Raste card.

Presented at the hackathon. The concept didn't place, but the end-to-end thinking, from research to UI to business model to physical card, within 24 hours demonstrates how I work under pressure.

8 DAY PROJECT

OCTOPOD

PROJECT BRIEF

What if autonomous cars could receive various types of logic instead of that used by humans, and had their own behaviour based on completely different types of intelligence to be adaptive, decentralized, and aware of their surroundings? What if a self-driving car didn't think like a human but like an octopus?

ABOUT

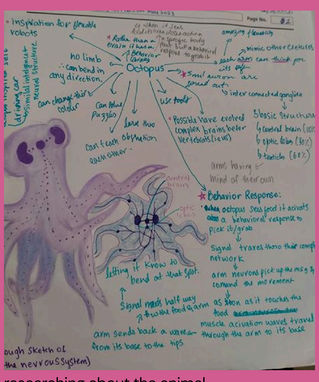
Octopuses have no centralised brain. Two-thirds of their neurons live in their arms, each capable of independent decision-making. Applied to autonomous vehicles: what if instead of one central system controlling everything, the car's intelligence was distributed — each sensor reacting to its immediate environment in real time, without waiting for a central command?

In 8 days I went from biological research to a functioning physical prototype — circuit diagrams, Arduin coding, soldering, wiring an L298N motor drive, and final assembly. The vehicle reacted to its environment in real time, not from pre-set rules.

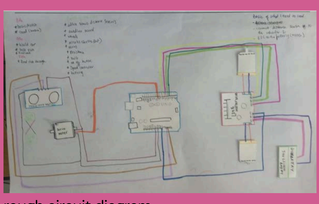
This project sits at the edge of UX — it asks who the "user" of an intelligent system is, and whether human-mimicking logic is the only valid model for designing behaviour. It's speculative, but grounded in a working prototype.

The prototype used ultrasonic sensors to detect proximity in real time. When an obstacle was sensed, the car autonomously adjusted its direction without any pre-programmed route or central instruction. Each response emerged from the immediate environment, not a predetermined map — closer to how an octopus arm reacts than how a human driver plans.

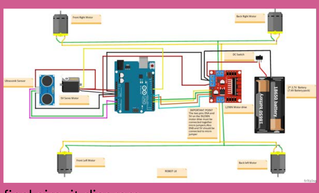
PROCESS



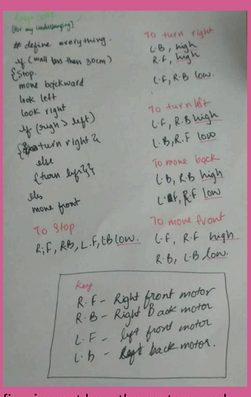
researching about the animal
(my case an octopus)



rough circuit diagram



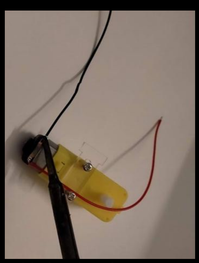
final circuit diagram



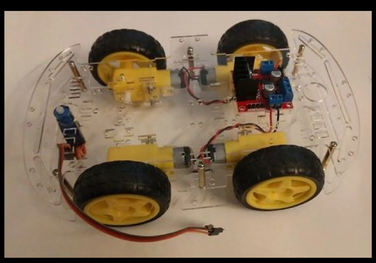
figuring out how the motors work

"Cephalopods are an independent experiment in the evolution of large brains and complex behaviour. if we can make contact with cephalopods as sentient beings it is neither because of a shared history nor because of kinship but because evolution built minds twice over...and if twice then likely many more."
-Peter Godfrey-Sm

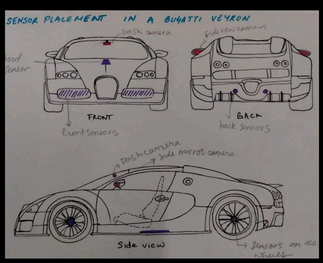
PROCESS



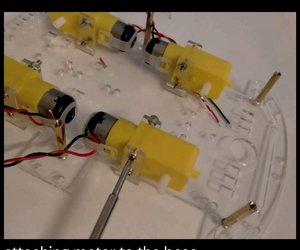
soldering the wires



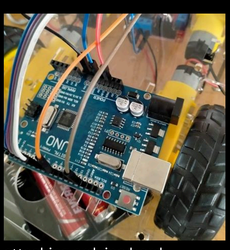
wiring the L298N motor drive



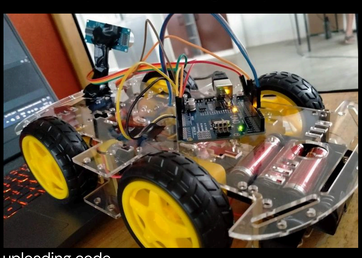
mock placement in a bugatti veyron



attaching motor to the base

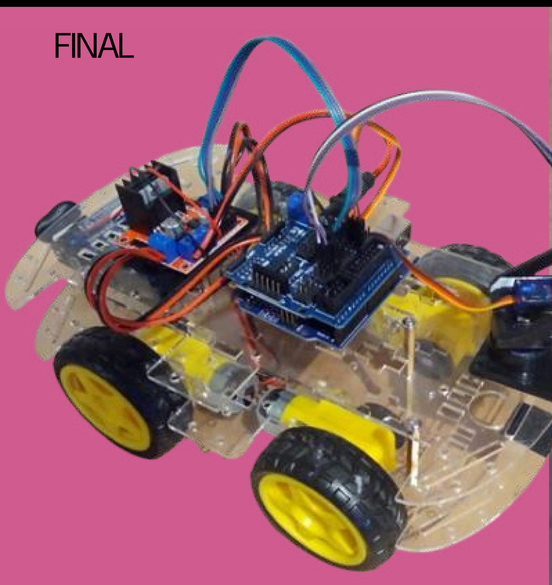


attaching arduino bord



uploading code

FINAL



4 MONTHS PROJECT

EX-BLURE

Enhancing navigation through intelligent assistance.

A Chrome extension that makes any website accessible for visually impaired users.

The Problem

What would the web feel like if vision wasn't a requirement to navigate it?

Many visually impaired users still struggle to navigate the web because most websites are built for sighted interaction. 88% of websites aren't fully accessibility-compliant. 71% of disabled users leave a non-accessible site immediately. Existing tools are fragmented, none solves everyday website navigation in one place.

This highlighted the need for a lightweight, browser-based solution that could simplify navigation, reduce cognitive load, and help users move through information quickly and confidently without depending entirely on traditional screen-reading workflows.

16% world's population live with a disability

88% of websites are not fully compliant

2.2 billion people have some form of vision impairment

71% of the disabled users, leave a website immediately

> "Their biggest struggle wasn't physical navigation — it was navigating existing websites. Websites were full of unlabeled buttons, poor contrast, confusing layouts, and missing screen-reader structure."
> — Students at Mathru Educational Trust for the Blind, Bengaluru

How I got here

Started with AI-powered smart glasses for real-world navigation. Pivoted to a Chrome extension after talking with visually impaired users, who said their biggest daily struggle was digital, not physical.

Research & observation
Visited Mathru Educational Trust; studied WCAG, screen readers, and 5+ existing tools. Found: existing solutions are fragmented, none solves daily website navigation.

Initial concept: AI smart glasses
Designed a voice-driven wearable with GPS, obstacle detection, and OCR. Built user personas and journey maps for two real users.

Pivot to Chrome extension
A browser extension intervenes exactly where accessibility breaks down, on the websites people already use, with no new hardware and no setup cost.

I started with AI-powered smart glasses for real-world navigation. Then I visited Mathru Educational Trust for the Blind in Bengaluru and talked to the students. Their biggest daily struggle wasn't physical, it was digital. Websites full of unlabelled buttons, poor contrast, confusing layouts, missing screen-reader structure. I scrapped the glasses and built a browser extension instead.

User journey map

- Age: 58
- Vision Condition: Completely blind due to diabetes
- Lifestyle: Mostly indoors but travels alone for essentials
- Tech Use: Beginner — uses voice assistants + calls family for help
- Mobility Aid: Smart cane + heavy dependence on audio feedback
- Goals: Independent banking and online payments

Frustrations

- Struggles with digital forms (PIN input, OTPs)
- Doesn't trust apps to guide him
- Gets overwhelmed by too much audio

Raghav Rao

Scenario: traveling alone to bank for essential transactions and digital payments
*Goal:*complete banking independently without family help

KEY TAKEAWAYS (TO DISPLAY UNDER INTERVIEW SLIDE)

- Provide layered feedback → vibration for danger, voice for guidance
- Prioritize predictability + safety
- Protect sensitive camera data
- UI must support different tech literacy levels
- Support both navigation + digital tasks

Phase 1 preparing	Phase 2 walking	Phase 3 entering the bank	Phase 4 ATM/ digital	Phase 5 returning
Actions calls family checks route	*Actions* follows voice directions	*Actions* asks staff waits in queue	*Actions* struggles with PIN and OTP	*Actions* walks back with cane
Emotions hesitant	*Emotions* overwhelmed	*Emotions* frustrated	*Emotions* very frustrated	*Emotions* relieved
Pain points dont trust tech needs family reassurance	*Pain points* too much audio complex instructions gets disoriented easily	*Pain points* can't see queue doesnt know where to go	*Pain points* can't read screen PIN input impossible OTP timeout too short	*Pain points* exhausted
Designer response voice only set up family sharing future pre journey walkthrough	*Designer response* simple commands	*Designer response* audio updates staff alert system indoor navigation	*Designer response* voice PIN entry extended otp timeout audio guidance for fields	*Designer response* simpler experience

This idea was different because it wasn't just a single accessibility feature, it was a fully integrated system that combined navigation, text reading, financial assistance, and personalization into one seamless experience. It focused on real-life independence, emotional confidence, and privacy-first design, making it more human-centered than existing tools.

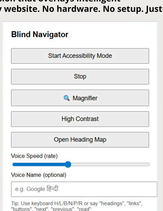
Gap analysis

Feature / Need	Be My Eyes	Envision AI	Aira	Seeing AI / Lookout	EX-BLURE
Navigation	✗	✗	✗	△	✓
Text & Object Recognition	△	✓	△	✓	✓
Hands-Free	△	✓	✗	△	✓
Task-Specific Guidance	✗	△	✓	△	✓
Independence	✗	△	△	△	✓
Offline Functionality	△	△	✗	△	✓
Ethical AI + Bias Handling	△	△	△	△	✓

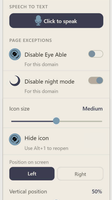
The final build

A lightweight Chrome extension that overlays intelligent navigation assistance on any website. No hardware. No setup. Just install and go.

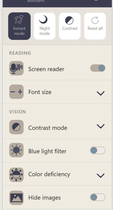
The final version of the extension integrated all tested features: voice commands, keyboard shortcuts, reading headings and buttons, high-visibility UI, and Start/Stop controls. It was lightweight, intuitive, and responsive, a practical solution that directly addressed the digital accessibility challenges identified throughout my research.



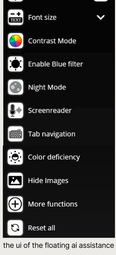
Ex-blure version 1



Ex-blure version 2 (ideation)



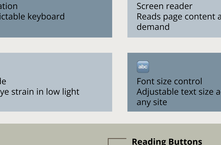
the pop up when clied on the extion



the ui of the floating ai assistance

THE FINAL OUTCOME
(made suing html, java script and css)

ICON
(the pop up icon which would be visible on the chrome browser)



magnifying glass

Voice commands
Navigate any webpage hands-free

Tab navigation
Fast, predictable keyboard control

Screen reader
Reads page content aloud on demand

Contrast modes
High contrast and colour deficiency support

Night mode
Reduces eye strain in low light

Font size control
Adjustable text size across any site

Voice Commands
Hands free control, natural commands, smooth navigation

Keyboard Shortcuts
H for headings, B for button, N/P for navigation, tactile feedback

Reading Headings
Detects structure, reduces line-by-line scanning, locates info faster

Accessibility Extension Features

Reading Buttons
Label recognition, provide context, user confidence

High Visibility UI
High-contrast design, focus highlights, pop-ups, multi sensory experience

Start/Stop controls
Activate/ deactivate, user control, critical interface

Testing outcomes

The extension was tested with visually impaired users at Mathru Educational Trust. They described it as simpler and less overwhelming than existing tools. The heading reader gave faster page orientation. Keyboard controls were preferred in real-world noise environments. Main gaps identified for the next version: icon-button detection and image alt-text reading.

Lighter and less overwhelming than existing tools

Heading reader gave faster page orientation

Keyboard controls preferred in real-world noise

Reflection

Accessibility isn't a checklist. Every decision in this project came back to one question: does this actually help someone live with more independence? It's a continuous commitment to empathy, iteration, and responsibility.

4 MONTHS PROJECT

CITY AS TEXT

How do you read a city that has been written by many different hands, over many different centuries, all at once?
A semester-long transdisciplinary inquiry into Kochi — not as a fixed geography but as a constructed narrative. Seven designers, seven lenses: Water, Time-Temporality, Port, Trade, Infrastructure, Community, Tourism. The outcome was a public exhibition at Kerala Museum, a participatory card system, and a digital archive.

The studio was anchored in Fort Kochi, Mattancherry, Muziris, Ernakulam, Vypin, and Willingdon Island. Outcomes emerged collaboratively, books, animations, films, texts, maps, and an exhibition, in partnership with Kerala Museum.

Project Overview

City as Text: Constructing the Alphabet.

How can we go past a single story of a place? What lies beyond the stereotypes that construct a city's image? City as Text is a trans-disciplinary pedagogical inquiry into ways of reading, unravelling, and understanding Kochi not as a fixed geography, but as a constructed narrative shaped by authors, power, and selective observation.

> "The city is never read the same way twice."

6th Edition - Kochi
Built on four prior editions of City as Text: Kerala Museum as institutional partner, Fort Kochi and Mattancherry as primary sites of inquiry.

Approach
Exhibition as Pedagogy
Not a final showcase, an interim, mobile, participatory tool. The exhibition visited the audience, not the other way around.

Lenses
7 Lenses, 1 Alphabet
Water, Time-Temporality, Port, Trade, Structure-Infrastructure, Community, Tourism, each a lever in a shared language for reading Kochi.

Dates
Jan: Kochi · Mattancherry · Vypin · Ernakulam · Muziris · Willingdon Island
Observation, conversation, mapping, documentation, with a focus on water and waterways.

My Role

Across this project, I served as Head of Branding, leading the visual identity and communication design for the entire exhibition. This included the creation of a bespoke typeface developed specifically for the project, all 7 lens icons and all 3 metaphor icons that formed the project's visual framework, and the full suite of exhibition panels, the primary City as Text panels, invitation panels, and spatial layout design. I produced the pamphlets and print collateral used across the exhibition. As Head of Branding, I directed the overall visual language of the project, working collaboratively with Janvi and Rithika on the broader colour system and typographic direction. I contributed to the card system design across all 8 card types, and owned the Time Temporality lens end-to-end, from field research and narrative development through to icon design. The project website was designed and built entirely by me, independently, in Framer.

In total, the visual identity of City as Text, the typeface, iconography, panels, pamphlets, and spatial layout encountered by visitors at Kerala Museum was created under my creative direction.

The Collective

Seven practitioners. Seven lenses.

Called themselves the Listeners Collective. Each brought a different dominant architecture, together they mapped toward ethical system design over radical aesthetic disruption.

Person 01
Understanding Ourselves
Archetype mapping, value studies, RSA Capabilities wheel, positionality, Team Think Constellation before the city, the self.

Person 02
Understanding Cities
Comparative analysis of Jaipur, Kolkata, Delhi, Chennai, Mumbai, Lucknow through assigned readings. Three anchors: Glossary, Insight, Quote.

Person 03
Forms of Engagement
MAP Museum, aPadagy Gallery, BIC-lectures: Kochi Biennale visited across 8 venues. 3 Framework: Information → Interpretation → Imagination.

Person 04
Kochi Immersion & Lens Development
First field visit: 200+ interviews. Collective affinity mapping. Archetypes built from recurring patterns across interviews.

Person 05
Typhelist Framework
Lenses reconceptualised as vowels (Water, Time-Temporality) and consonants (Port, Trade, Infrastructure, Community, Tourism). Three metaphors: Palimpsest, Maze, Centre-Margin.

Person 06
Cards, Branding & A2 Build
8 card types developed. Bespoke typeface 7 lens icons. Colour system. Panel narrative flow designed. Print + install over 2 days.

Person 07
A2 Exhibition at Kerala Museum
Two-day public exhibition. Guided walks, two workshops, Water Metro engagement.

Person 08
Working Towards A3
Website development, translating all physical collateral into a digital archive. A3 forthcoming.

Phase 05

Seven lenses. One alphabet.

To read Kochi as a text, a language of interpretation had to be constructed. The seven lenses were reconceptualised as an alphabet, vowels that connect and consonants that structure. Three metaphors describe how the letters interact: Palimpsest, Maze, and Centre to Margins.

Time–Temporality as Lens

When you look at Kochi through time, the city no longer feels linear. Tides return daily, the monsoon arrives with shifting consequences, and festivals create temporary intensities. Migration reshapes neighbourhoods slowly, while infrastructure and aspiration accelerate everyday life. Some lives follow ancestral rhythms of water and work; others move to faster urban tempos. Past decisions remain visible in streets, buildings, and routines, layering multiple temporalities into a present shaped by overlapping times.

How are temporal rhythms altered to accommodate tourism?

Whose rhythms continue to shape Kochi as others speed up or fade?

What determines which memories remain visible and what fades away?

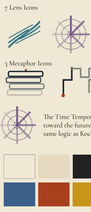
How do tides, seasons, and waterways influence the rhythms through which Kochi is lived?

Phase 06

8 card types. One participatory system.

Cards were not supplementary, they were the exhibition's core interactive layer. Visitors selected, sorted, ranked, and responded. The exhibition became a cumulative, evolving archive of perspectives.

Card Types Developed
Common Cards



Entry points and provocations not seeking answers, seeking engagement

Key terms defined contextually not dictionary definitions

Connections, observations we made based on our readings and experience

Direct quotes from interviews, preserved tone, minimal modification

Exhibition title poster

Structured profiles from fieldwork, not individuals, but patterns

Secondary readings from other cities conceptual anchors for city literacy

Lenses Cards

Water-lens Provocation Lens-specific, gather insights from visitors, challenge assumptions.

Time lens Relationships Visualise interconnections between lenses, actors, and conditions.

Community lens Timeline A timeline of the each lens and how it has evolved and how it can further develop into (the above images is one out of the 4 pages)

Trade lens Archetype Composite personas from 200+ interviews enable visitor identification.

Visual Identity

A language built for the city, not borrowed from one

Branding was developed collaboratively by Janvi, Rithika, and Kshirabdija. Typography, colour, and iconography were treated as structural decisions — not decorative ones.

7 Lens Icons

3 Metaphor Icons

The Time Temporality icon is a motion clock where the lines reduce in opacity as they radiate outward, suggesting movement toward the future. The dotted circles represent stagnancy, history and memory held in place even as time moves forward. It's the same logic as Kochi's buildings: structurally constant, but more layered with every passing decade.

City As Text:
Constructing The Alphabet
The Kochi Edition
The City Is Never Read The Same Way Twice.
LENS_01 / WATER /
SITES-KM-2024

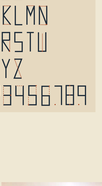
Every colour in the palette was pulled directly from a specific place we visited in Kochi. The rust of fort walls, the green of backwater edges, the ochre of spice markers. The palette was intentionally vibrant because that's how we experienced the city, alive, layered, contradictory.

Phase 07

City as Text: Constructing the Alphabet

A three-room experience at Kerala Museum. Seven lenses as vowels and consonants. The exhibition was not a display of conclusions, it was a space designed to do something to the person walking through it.

- Lenses Developed
- Water Metro Interviews
- Voice & people cards
- Workshop Participants



Community Engagement Outcomes

Kochi Metro
Exhibition as Active Inquiry
Participants selected resonant cards, identified archetypes, spotted gaps, then added their own Voice Cards, turning the exhibition into a cumulative, growing archive.

Workshop 01 · 8 Participants
Visual Analogue Dialogue
Lens ranking exercise revealed personal hierarchies of the city. Metaphor discussion: Palimpsest resonated most at Kerala Museum, participants connected with Kochi as a layered city.

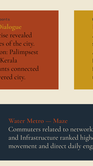
Workshop 02 · 57 Participants
Design Arguments
Agree/Disagree/Unrelatable sorting of Voice Cards. Archetypes were perceived as fluid, participants challenged fixed categories. Each created their own People Profile card.

Metaphor Validation · Kerala Museum to Water Metro

Kerala Museum: Palimpsest
Participants connected to Kochi as layered, past and present coexisting. Community, Water, Time ranked highest. Metaphors grounded in visible, lived experience were more effective.

Water Metro — Maze
Commuters related to networks, routes, and connections. Water and Infrastructure ranked highest. Metaphors grounded in movement and direct daily engagement were more effective.

Facilitated and conducting a workshop



Conducting a walk in KM

Affinity Mapping based on our insights

Ranking the Metaphors with Participants at the Water Metro

Thank you!

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